

Mata o Muna 9 | Chapter 9

Maumea o te Fenua | Wealth of the Island

Tuvalu

English

A te mata o muna tenei e fakamatala i ai a te maumea, mea faigaluega, mō mea taulima kolā ni mafai ai a kautama o Nanumea o maua he olaga 'lei o lātou i luga i te olotou fenua. E iai hoki ni tala i auala faka te fenua ni mafai o maua i te faka galuegaga o te laukele, kae pelā mō te puipuiga o fuataga o niu mai kimoa. E fakamatala hoki i konei a galuega a tino e fai i laukele faka te fenua. Koa fakaholoatu hoki te ukega a mea koa maua mai te niu.

This chapter describes the resources, tools and handicrafts that allowed generations of Nanumeans to make a comfortable living on their island. Information is also provided about some of the traditional ways of working the land, especially those that protected the coconut crop from rats. The work parties that used to harvest coconuts on the communal lands are also described. There is also a list of the many items produced by the coconut palm.

Laukele mo Laumanafa

A te laukele o te fenua kātoa (e hē aofia i ai a tana kaupapa) koa oti ni vaevae me ni katikati ki lau-manafa foliki. A te lāhiga o te laukele tenei koa tofu ailoa a matakāiga mō olotou laumanafa. Kae ko laukele faka te fenua konei koa fakamatala atu mai lalo ni laukele kolā e pule e te fenua. A laukele konā e faka igoa ki te Manafa Tapu. E aofia i ai:

- Te Manafa Tapu i Lakena: E i ai he fakamatalaga e fai pelā me mai mua malie o te koko, o fano ki mua i te mata o Lakena, he laukele fakapoopo katoa tenā. Telā lā koa fai mō laukele e pule i ai a te fenua.
- TafegaĀtua: He laukele tenei e tū i matagi, fakalava o te namo. A te ia ni e fakapoopo hoki. Telā lā koa oko ki ai a te pule a te fenua.
- Te Toki: He laukele mai namo, ni fakapoopo e te kau Amelika i te taimi o te Taua II i te Lalolagi. E tū pili nei i ai a te akoga lasaga muamua a te malo. A te laukele tenei koa mai lalo hoki i te pule a te fenua. Kae i te tauhaga 2026, e pelā me e māōfa te toki, e hē toe fakaaogā.
- Manafa i te Fusi: He laukele fakapoopo hoki. E i ai he pā foliki e tu pili ki mō mea konei, kae koa i ai hoki ni lākau koa ola i ai. Ni tali katoa e te fenua mō 'pono mai tai i mō mea konei, ke tū i ai a te Fusi a te fenua.

A laumanafa takitaki e tofu ailoa mō tona igoa kae ni tuku fakaholo ifo ailoa ki lalo e olotou tino mua. A igoa o laumanafa e i ai ni uiga o lātou. Penei mo:

- Hahake: e faka iloa mai me i te laukele tenei e tū pelā ki te faitu ki te fanakega o te lā.
- TafegaĀtua: ko mō mea kolā e faka'tafe tele i ai aitu (me atua mua o te fenua) i taimi o tai 'lahi. E mafai o lagona a leo (atu lā ni aitu) e fai fatele mai matagi i TafegaĀtua i taimi o kau mahina, kae malū hoki a te matagi.

Land and Landholdings

Most of the land on Nanumea atoll has been divided up into small holdings that are owned by families and individuals. (Its reef is not divided.) However, the communally-owned lands listed below have not been divided up but instead are owned and used by the community as a whole. These lands are called Manafa Tapu. Some of them are:

- Te Manafa Tapu in Lakena: The explanation for this communal land is that long ago, the land near Te Koko pond was the southern end of Lakena islet and the land that is now there gradually accreted over time. This is why this land is communally owned.
- TafegaĀtua: This land is located across the lagoon from the village on Matagi. It also gradually accreted and this is why it is communally-owned.
- Te Toki: This land along the lagoon shore was built up by the American military during the Second World War. The government primary school was built just inland from this land in the 1960s. By 2026, the dock had begun to crumble and was no longer useable.
- Manafa i te Fusi: This land was gradually built up also, developing from a reef flat that had a little vegetation growing on it. The community agreed to enclose it from the seawater and built the Cooperative Store on it.

All landholdings on Nanumea are named and their names have been passed down from our ancestors over time. Some names involve particular meanings:

- Hahake: It is said that this land is located in the direction of the sunrise.
- TafegaĀtua: This is the place whose water is made to flow by spirits at high tide. You can hear voices which are singing fātele over in Matagi at Tafegātua when there is a full moon and the wind is calm.

- Te Āfaga o Maumau: Ko mō mea kolā e noho tele i ai a te feao (atua mua) tenei o Nanumea e igoa ki a Maumau.
- Te Lahi: He laukele hoki e mahani o noho tele i ai a te aitū tenei e igoa ki a Telāhi.
- Falekouga: E i ai he tala e uiga ki te tagata Kilipati tenei e igoa ki a Kouga, ni taumafai o fakatū a tona fale i te mata fenua ki vao o Lakena, ka ni 'tā fakamuli ifo.

A laumanafa konei e lahi 'kī a te 'hekega i saisi o lātou. E iai manafa koa foliki ifo i pō nei i te mea he vaega telā koa oti ni 'kati mai luga o he manafa lahi muamua, kae koa vaevae nei ki potu foliki. Ko te laukele tenei e fakavae ki ai a te maumea o te fenua telā e 'tau o fakagaluegina e ona tāgata.

Tausiga o te Manafa Tapu i Lakena

A te Manafa Tapu he laukele e tai mata lahi fakagāmua a te fenua. E tū i te motu tenei ko Lakena, kae a te maumea o te fenua ni maua mai i ai i pō mua i te mea ko ana takataka. Ko te laukele o te Manafa Tapu koa oti ni vaevae ki vaega e fā e faka igoa ki epa. E faka'pau ki potopotoga e fā ko Kalofia, Lesili, Vakalele mo Usitai.

I te taimi telā koa tonu i ai me koa olo o faite a te Manafa Tapu, e hēai ailoa he tino e 'tau o noho i Nanumea (nā e i ai he pogai 'tau) mai te 16-50 tauhaga o te olaga. A toeaina tai matua'tua e mafai hoki o olo, o 'noho i mua i te āhiga o filofilo olotou mō kolokolo kae pula'pula ki te galue'lue a tamatāne mo tamāfine i olotou tafa. Konei lā a galuega e 'tau o fai:

- Tāgata tai matuatua e hua vao, kae ko fāfine matua'tua e 'luku a niu.
- Ko tamatane tai 'lahi kolā koa iloa e lātou o afeafe, e olo mō olotou kāgega, loulou, mō olotou tui lau e fusi i olotou kuoga. A te mea tāua i te galuega tenei ko te puipuiga o te auala o te kimoa, ke mō ā e fakamahe i lātou a fuataga o niu.
- Ā ko te tokoukega o tamatāne e tofu mō te koho, koa fakaholo o oka a fakatupuga niu a fāfine matua'tua kolā koa oti ni fakaputu.
- Ko tamāfine mō olotou titi fakamanumanu mō olotou fau/titivao, e takitokolua telā kauamo mō telā kete. Koa kāmata nei o tali a niu kolā koa oti ni oka ki mua i te āhiga.
- I mua i te āhiga e i ai hoki ailoa ni tino mai epa takitahi e tau e lātou a olotou niu. A te faiga o te galuega tenei, pelā hoki ailoa me fakataufai me koai e oti muamua a lātou niu ni oka.

Kae fai e vave a te oka a tamatāne, e mafai o oti i tua malie o te tutonu. Kae fai ailoa e 'lei a te puipuiga o te kimoa a te niu e mafai ailoa o oko pelā ki te sefuluafe o fano ki luga. Koa oti koa toe fai hoki ni kāfaga e lua, he

- Te Āfaga o Maumau: This is where the spirit named Maumau lived.
- Te Lahi: This land is where one of the island's traditional gods, Telahi, hung out.
- Falekouga: There is a story told about a Gilbertese man named Kouga who tried to build his house here at the tip of Lakena, but he was later killed.

Land holdings vary greatly in size. Those that are small are fragments from what was once a much larger piece. The atoll's land provides the foundation on which local life depends.

Care of the Communal Lands (Manafa Tapu) in Lakena

The "Sacred Land" (Manafa Tapu) is quite a large parcel of communally-owned land on the islet of Lakena. It is planted in coconut palms and, in the past, these were harvested collectively to produce income from copra. The communal land has been divided into four quarters called epa, each looked after by one of four work groups: Kalofia, Lesili, Vakalele and Usitai.

When it is time to work on the Manafa Tapu, all those aged 16–50 are expected to participate. Elderly men also go to Lakena and roll sennit cord inside the Lakena āhiga, watching the younger workers nearby. This is the work that needs to be done:

- Older men cut down underbrush around the palms while the older women gather the brown coconuts together into piles.
- Younger men who know how to afeafe (trim coconut leaves) go from tree to tree with their ladders and long-handled cutters. The purpose of this work is to prevent rats from running along from one tree to another, gnawing on young coconuts, and destroying the crop.
- The rest of the younger men start husking the piles of coconuts that the women have gathered.
- Young women wearing brown fakamanumanu skirts, decorated with head wreaths and leaf skirts, work in pairs to bring baskets of husked coconuts up on carrying poles to the āhiga.
- In front of the āhiga, a person from each epa counts the husked coconuts brought up by their group. The epa groups work competitively, each trying to finish husking their coconuts first.

Depending on the young men's speed at husking, they can finish just after noon. The epa group that has brought in the most nuts is announced, and also the one with the least. If the past protection of the coconut crop from rats has been successful, there could be 10,000 or even more

kāfaga lima mo te kāfaga vae. Mai niu katoa kolā ni tufa ki kāiga, e 'tau katoa ailoa o pei mō fai a takataka.

Lākau

Lākau Kaina o te Fenua

fala felo kaleve-gau laukatafa maika maisoa mei niu olesi panikenī pateta pulaka tāmū talo

Vaega o Talo mo Pulaka

Vaega a talo maua i ai i Nanumea e kau i ai: manua, kilisome, talo uli, talo tea, talo fiti, talo lanulanu. Vaega a pulaka maua i ai i Nanumea e kau i ai: tinā pulaka ailoa, pulaka kula, te ikamāva, te ika makini, te ika kula, te ika afi, pulaka faitaliga, te ika laoi, pulaka lau uke, pulaka lau pikipiki.

Te niu (Coconut Palm)

Atu lā ko te toe lākau tafahili ailoa tenei i te aogā ni fakaola ake i te lalolagi, mailoga i fenua o te pasefika. A vaega katoa o te lākau tenei e aogā katoa, e kāmata mai tona tafito i lalo, ke oko ailoa ki luga i tona taulu. Tenei ke fakamatala atu a aogā valevale o te niu:

- meakai: a ona fuataga, e maua i ai a mukomuko, pī, uto, motomoto, niu, takataka 'kula, u'tanu, kaleve.
- mea inu: a te pī e tahi, e mafai ailoa a koe o makona mana inu ki ai.
- te fale: e mafai ailoa o katoa a mea o te fale i te lākau tenei ko te niu.
- kāpa o te fale: ko launiu kolā e 'laga ki ai a pola mo ato a te fale ke malu mai te ua.
- laupapa o te fale: ko te foitino o te niu e maua i ai a laupapa mo pou o te fale.
- lolo: te lolo e maua mai niu valu kolā koa oti ni 'tau.
- kapeni: te toe tulaga ailoa o te kaleve kula, telā e faka vela ailoa ke oko ki te taimi koa hoko 'kī a te kaleve.
- hinu: e valu a niu, koa 'tau i ai a te lolo. Koa faka vela i ai ki te afi mō fai a meakai.
- sene/tupe: te takataka, mō mea taulima e uke e mafai o maua mai te niu, ka mafai o fakatau.

Meakai

Ko te 'kai 'lei a te Nanumea e 'tau o tapa tolu, telā e aofia i ai a: he ika, he meakai lākau, mo he niu. A te niu e mähani o 'gau pelā me ni faiga pakupaku mai te niu makeke. Kae ko e lomātua, e mähani o valu a niu mō lātou.

coconuts. All the coconuts distributed to families should be made into copra.

Plants

Edible Plants

fala felo kaleve-gau laukatafa maika maisoa mei niu olesi panikenī pateta pulaka tāmū talo

Varieties of Taro and Pulaka

Some of the varieties of taro found on Nanumea include manua, kilisome, talo uli, talo tea, talo fiti, and talo lanulanu. Types of pulaka found on Nanumea include tinā pulaka ailoa, pulaka kula, te ikamāva, te ika makini, te ika kula, te ika afi, pulaka faitaliga, te ika laoi, pulaka lau uke, and pulaka lau pikipiki.

Te niu (Coconut Palm)

Undoubtedly this is the single most useful plant in the world, especially in Pacific islands. Every part of the coconut palm is useful, from its roots at the bottom to its crown at the top. Some of the many uses of the coconut palm include:

- Food: from the coconut's fruit come mukomuko, pī, uto, motomoto, niu, takataka 'kula, u'tanu, kaleve, and many other food items.
- Drink: a single pī can fully satisfy one's thirst.
- The house: almost everything needed to build a house can come from the coconut palm.
- House roof: coconut leaves woven into panels and thatch to keep out the rain.
- House timber: the trunk of the coconut provides floorboards and house posts.
- Coconut cream (lolo): extracted from grated mature coconuts.
- Toffee (kapeni): the final stage of boiling coconut sap until it sets.
- Oil (hinu): extracted by heating grated coconut and used for cooking or body care.
- Money: the husk, and many handicraft items made from the coconut, can be sold for income.

Foods

To be satisfying, a traditional Nanumean meal should be tapa tolu, that is, it should include three things: some fish, some filling food made from plants, and some coconut (niu). Usually, the coconut is in the form of crunchy slices, freshly cut from the mature nut. However, for older people, the coconut is usually grated.

A mea 'kai valevale a Nanumea e maua i ai: fakahega, fakahakava, fakalala, fakalotuma, fakamatakanofi, fakapolouto, falifu mei, falifu talo, falifu pulaka, fausi, fekei, fuaniu, kilivaka, laulu, likoliko, milimilikilagi, nepo, niu ni'nini, otai, papai, pepeifua, pihakalo, poi, pota, puatolo, puleleti, solomei, suasua, supu mei, supu olesi, vaihuu'huu, faka'pa.

Meakai e Mau

- Niu mo takataka 'kula: Koa tauaki a niu i luga i te fale'umu. Koa ola haohao a meakai i loto i te niu ke pelā me 'kula. A takataka 'kula konā koa mau mō tauhaga e uke.
- Gutu lua: A u'tanu e tauaki i loto i he olo i lalo o te oneone e faka igoa ki ai. Koa gali atu a niu i te takauaga o taimi.
- Likoliko: A pulaka kolā koa tunu e faifai kae tauaki ki te lā, kae tauaki i loto i papa niu i luga i te fale'umu. E 'kai ki palu mō kaleve, vai me lolo, kae tunu i loto i papa niu i loto i te umu.
- Kaleve kula: A te kaleve kolā koa faka vela ke pelā me molasi matī, e mau mō tauhaga e lahi.

Manu

E hē uke mālosi a manu fagai i luga i Nanumea. Ka e tai uke a vaegā manulele valevale. Kae mai te tai e mafai o lavea a te uke o vaegā mea ola valevale e aofia i ai a vaega paka e uke, pelā hoki mo ula, kae mailoga i ai ko ika.

Manu Tausi a te Kāiga

kulī moa puaka puhi take

Manu 'Lele

akiaki fougā gogo kaleva kanapu katafa kotau lakia lupe matuku toloa tuli

Manu Kaina e 'Tolo i te Laukele

kamakama kaviki paikea tupa ū

Manu Kaina e 'Tolo i te Tai

fāhua hahule hōpu kula hōpu nifo hōpu papa kahi kahifa kohi matakivikivi matamea paka panea pipi pohina tifa tugage ula

Manu e Hē Kaina i te Laukele

akalava anufe fakamū kalihi kefu kimoa lago lo loata logologo moko molokau namo pepe tamukihu

Many kinds of Nanumean recipes can be prepared from the island's edible plants: fakahega, fakahakava, fakalala, fakalotuma, fakamatakanofi, fakapolouto, falifu mei, falifu talo, falifu pulaka, fausi, fekei, fuaniu, kilivaka, laulu, likoliko, milimilikilagi, nepo, niu ni'nini, otai, papai, pepeifua, pihakalo, poi, pota, puatolo, puleleti, solomei, suasua, supu mei, supu olesi, vaihuu'huu, faka'pa.

Long-lasting Food Stores

- Niu and takataka 'kula: Coconuts were stored in the attic of the cook house. As they aged, the meat inside became denser and reddish in color. These well-aged coconuts (takataka 'kula) would keep for many years.
- Gutu lua: Sprouted coconuts (u'tanu) were kept in a special underground storage pit. Periodically, the pit was excavated and the sprouting tips trimmed, then the nuts replaced. The coconuts become sweeter and denser as time passes.
- Likoliko: Cooked pulaka is sliced thinly, dried in the sun, and stored in coconut shells in the attic. When eaten, likoliko is mixed with kaleve, water or lolo, and baked in the shells in an earth oven.
- Kaleve kula: Sap from the coconut palm (kaleve) is boiled down until it forms a thick molasses, which can be kept for a very long time.

Animals

Only a few domesticated animals are raised on Nanumea. However, there are several kinds of wild birds. The ocean offers a much greater diversity of animal life, including crabs and many kinds of shellfish, as well as fish.

Domesticated Animals

kulī moa puaka puhi take

Birds

akiaki fougā gogo kaleva kanapu katafa kotau lakia lupe matuku toloa tuli

Edible Crawling Animals

kamakama kaviki paikea tupa ū

Edible Crawling Sea Creatures

fāhua hahule hōpu kula hōpu nifo hōpu papa kahi kahifa kohi matakivikivi matamea paka panea pipi pohina tifa tugage ula

Non-Edible Crawling Land Animals

akalava anufe fakamū kalihi kefu kimoa lago lo loata logologo moko molokau namo pepe tamukihu

Te Milo

A te Milo, he vai. Kae i te kaugutu o te vai tenei, e uke a te lākau tenei, te milo. E mālosi mo makeke manafai koa taiki, ka e hē tupu lahi pelā mo te fetau. Konei a aogā o te lākau tenei:

- e fai ki ai a muli-pou, me e fui 'pala i lalo i te one.
- e fai ki ai a kautae, telā lā e lahi a te manakogina o te lākau tenei e tautai.
- e gali hoki i te fai ki ai a kiato o vaka.
- e mafai hoki o fakaogā mō fai a pou o te fale.
- pelā hoki mō faiga o mea taulima, pelā moa ta o vaka foliki.

Telā lā a koe e manako o fakaogā a te lākau tenei i mea konei e fakāli atu mai luga, a koe ke fano o togi muamua ki te failautuhi o te fenua.

Tona Tai: Moana mo te Namu

Tahi o maumea tāua tenei o te fenua ko tona tai. Telā e mafai o maua mai i ai a ika e uke, kolā e aogā mō te tausiga o te olaga. I pō mua a tino Nanumea e ola ailoa i ana mō ika e kiki ki mō niu. I pō nei, i te mea koa mau luga 'kī a te mālosi o sene, telā lā koa manakogina a te maumea o te tai ke fakaliu sene mō fesoasoani o fakataunu ki ai a manakoga o te sene.

Tino Gālua 'Togi

Kae i loto i te 1920-30, i te taliaga o tino Nanumea o saina ki Panapa mo Nauru, ni tai maua i ai a te mainaga 'lei e uiga ki te aogā o te sene. E hē leva hoki kae oko atu ki Nanumea a te faitega o Fusi. I pō hoki ailoa konā, koa i ai he auala e tai faigofie i te aumaiga o sene mai Panapa mo Nauru ki kāiga i fenua. Telā ko te aumai i te telemo.

Telā lā, pelā me ko Panapa, Nauru mo Talava ni kāmata mai ai a te maumea tenei ko te sene. Mai te 1960 koa tai tokouke i ai a tino koa gālua i te Kolone o Kilipati mo Elise. Ke oko mai ki te taimi nei, koa tokouke 'kī a tino koa gālua i te Mālō o Tuvalu, pelā hoki mō Kamupane valevale. Tokouke hoki konei koa malaku atu ki Niusila mo fenua ake i loto i te Pasefika.

Mea Fai Galuega

I loto i senitenali e uke koa nohoakigina i ai, kae koa kāmata hoki o atiake i ai a te fenua e tino Nanumea, e uke a vaega mea faigaluega e mafai o fakāogā ki faiga o mea fai ika, pelā hoki mō galuega i olotou manafa. Ke oko hoki

Te Milo Pond

Te Milo is a pond with very mildly-brackish water on whose banks grow many milo trees. Mature milo trees have wood that is very strong and fine-grained. Some uses of milo include:

- The base of house posts buried in the ground, since this wood is slow to rot underground.
- Long handles for flying fish nets.
- The struts connecting the canoe hull and outrigger together.
- Entire house posts.
- Handicrafts, such as model canoes.

Anyone who wants to use this tree is required to purchase what they need from the Island Secretary, thereby providing some income to the community.

Sea Resources: Ocean and Lagoon

One of the most valuable forms of island wealth comes from the sea. In the past, Nanumeans say that they 'lived from its fish and coconut.' Today, however, the effect of the money economy has changed people's access to the wealth of the sea. Most fishermen now sell their catch, and families also buy much of their protein food from the store.

Salaried Employees

Resident European traders established small stores on many Tuvalu islands from about the 1860s onward. By about 1920–30, when Nanumean men began to be hired to work on Banaba and Nauru, understanding of the value and uses of money developed. An Island Cooperative Store was established in Nanumea and copra earnings could be used to buy sugar and other things. In those days, workers at Banaba and Nauru sent money home via Telemo ('telegraphic money order').

From 1960, the number of people employed by the Gilbert and Ellice Islands Colony government kept growing. Following this came the opportunity for young men to work as crew on overseas ships. Today, many people are employed by the government of Tuvalu or in various private companies. Nanumeans are also moving to live and work in New Zealand and other Pacific Islands.

Tools

In the centuries that Nanumeans inhabited and developed their island, they used a wide variety of tools as they fished and worked their lands. Since the atoll environment did not offer metal or volcanic stone, people had to

ailoa ki mea ake kolā e 'tau o fai ki ai ni mea faigaluega e faigatā 'kī ailoa o maua i he fenua penei. Kae faitalia i ai ni mafai o faka talenigina a lātou, mai te 'gali a olotou pogalima.

Hika

Ko te faiga ke maua a te afi. E lua a lākau e fakaaogā tele mō fai a te hika, me koa 'tū gofie. Ko te lākau ko te pua, kae tahi ko te aloalo. Kae ko lākau malō katoa e mafai ailoa o maua a te afi mai ai. E tokotahi e taofi a te kauhika telā e fakamoe i lalo, ka e tokotahi e puke a te matahika. Atu lā me 2-3 minute ko te mea ailoa koa lavea atu e koe a te afi koa kā.

Toki Fahua

He faitu fahua e tahi koa oti ni ololoo ke mata'kai ki fatu fakatala'tala kolā e maua i mata katoga. Koa 'fau i ai ki te kau toki (kau fetau) me 1½ futu a te loa, kae 1½ inisi a te mātolu, kae ko tona mata ki mua e tai lauefa kae piko ki loto pelā me he 60°. Tenei a te mea faigaluega e talai ki ai a vaka, tanoa, kumete.

Tipatipa

E penā hoki ailoa mō te toki, nā i tona mata ki mua e tai maofe ka e mafai o miomio ki mō mea kolā e loto ki ai a te tino talai. Kae telā lā ko faitu mai loto o te vaka, telā e mafai i ai a te vaka o fano o tai pukupuku.

Makākafa

Ko ia tenei e fakaaogā e filo ki ai a kolokolo mo kafa. Fakaaogā hoki mō fai ki ai a tauaga mō 'tau a te lolo, kae mō fakamā hoki a kaleve. Ko vaegā niu kolā e kafa 'loa ka e kae 'fao ki loto i tāpola. Koa 'kave i ai o 'tao i tai me 2-3 mahina. Koa tuki i ai a okaga konei koa malū.

Kolo Kolo

A te kolokolo e lua a nino, e tuku ki tou kauaga, kae fakamafilo ki tou alofi-lima. A te kolokolo e fakaaogā malosī mō: fai ki ai a 'li o kaleve, 'fau a teu, 'fau a te ama mo palepaleama o te vaka, mo ato ki ai a te fale, mo lulu a 'pui.

Kafa

E tai mālosi atu a te kafa i te kolokolo. A te kafa e tolu a nino e fakaaogā, kae koa hē filo pelā mō te kolokolo kae koa fakaaogā a lima e lua mō fili a te kafa. A te kafa e fakaaogā mō 'fau a te vaka, mo 'fau a te fatafatāfale o he fale.

Koho

A te koho e 'tau ailoa a faite ki he lākau makeke pelā mō te 'gie, kae me ko hēai he 'gie e ola i Nanumea, telā lā koa fakaaogā i ai a te fetau, me he togo. E noho pelā ki te tolu futu a te loa, kae lua inisi a te mātolu. E fakaaogā mō oka a niu, ū'tanu, motomoto mo pi.

depend on the limited local alternatives. Though raw materials were limited, this was more than offset by the ingenuity of their design and the craftsmanship evident in their construction.

Hika (Fire-Making)

The method of making fire. Two types of wood are most used, as they ignite easily: pua and aloalo, though any hard wood will work. One person holds the base piece (kauhika) flat on the ground while another works the fire-stick (matahika) back and forth over it. Within 2-3 minutes fire can be obtained.

Toki Fahua (Adze)

A clam shell ground to a sharp edge on a rough surface found at low tide. Fitted to a fetau-wood handle about 1½ feet long and 1½ inches thick, with a flat blade curved inward at about 60°. This is the tool used to carve canoes, wooden bowls (tanoa), and food pounders (kumete).

Tipatipa (Curved Adze)

Similar to the toki, but its blade is more flexible and can be turned to carve in whatever direction the carver wishes. It is especially used to carve the inside of the canoe hull to make the vessel sleek.

Makākafa (Coconut Fibre Preparation)

This is used to prepare fibre for rolling into sennit cord (kolokolo) and braided cord (kafa). It is also used to make strainers for extracting coconut cream (lolo) and filtering coconut sap (kaleve). Coconut husks are soaked in seawater for 2-3 months, then beaten until soft.

Kolokolo (Sennit Cord)

Sennit cord uses two strands, placed on the thigh and rolled with the palm of the hand. It is widely used for: binding the coconut sap funnel, lashing decorations, securing the canoe outrigger and its supports, thatching the house, and lashing the wall panels and cookhouse framework.

Kafa (Braided Cord)

Braided cord is stronger than sennit cord. It uses three strands and is braided with both hands rather than rolled on the thigh. Kafa is used for lashing the canoe hull and for securing the wall beams of a house.

Koho (Husking Stick)

The husking stick is best made from a very hard wood like gie, but since no gie grows on Nanumea, fetau or togo is used instead. It is about three feet long and two inches thick, sharpened to two points. It is used for husking coconuts, sprouted nuts (u'tanu), half-ripe nuts and pī.

Loulou

He kaufetau vikiviki, kae noho pelā ki te 5-6 mita a te loa, mō te mata naifi me he mea mata'kai e 'hai ki te mata ki mua. E fakaaogā mō tau mei, pelā hoki ko te afeafega o mata o launiu mō puipui a te auala o kimoa mai te fakamahei e lātou a fuataga o niu.

Kakega

E lua a lākau e 'pau i te 'loa (6-7 futu a te 'loa kae 2 inisi a te mātolu). Koa 'fau i ai a leka (8-10 inisi a te 'loa) ki luga i lākau konei e lua. A te vāhia o te leka ki te leka e noho pelā ki te futu e tahi. E fakaaogā mō kake, e fakaaogā hoki i te taimi e fano a koe o gālue i ou manafa i vao, pelā hoki mō te manafa tapu i Lakena.

Te Lō/Kāfaga

A te lo e māhani o faite ki te kānava telā koa taiki. E 18 inisi a te loa o te kaukanava, kae taki 5 inisi mai mata ki tafa o te lākau o fano ki loto koa fakakauvae malie ki loto. I te kauvae tenei koa 'hai i ai a kavei e tolu. Kae oti koa toe fai hoki ni kāfaga e lua, he kāfaga lima mo te kafaga vae. A kāfaga e fakaaogā mō kake ki luga i te niu.

Mea Taulima

He tahi hoki o auala tenei e mafai ai o maua ni sene o faopopo ki te maumea o te fenua: mea taulima. A te ukega o mea koa fai pelā me ni mea taulima i aso nei, ni mea hoki ailoa e aogā mō te olaga i pō takitahi i taimi koa olo, ia me ni ata foliki o mea konei. I pō nei a mea taulima koa mafai o fakatau atu ki tua, ia me fakaaogā nei hoki ailoa, kae mailoga i ai i luga i Funafuti nei.

E uke 'kī a vaega mea taulima kolā e mafai o maua i luga i te fenua: epa, papa, titi fakamanumanu, titi galegale, ato, ili, tui, galegale lanu valevale, pūlou mo mea ake hoki. Tāgata hoki e mafai o fai a vaega mea penei: vaka foliki, kumete/tuki, fāoga, kolokolo, kafa, ketuketu, kau seluselu.

Loulou (Long Pole Cutter)

A slender fetau pole about 5-6 meters long with a sharp knife blade tied to the front end. Used for harvesting breadfruit, and also for the afeafe work of trimming coconut fronds to prevent rats from running from tree to tree and gnawing the young coconuts.

Kakega (Ladder)

Two poles of equal length (6-7 feet long, 2 inches thick) with rungs (8-10 inches long) tied between them. The rungs are spaced about one foot apart. Used for climbing, and also when going to work on land parcels in the bush, or on the communal Manafa Tapu in Lakena.

Te Lō / Kāfaga (Coconut Climbing Device)

The lo is usually made from dried kanava wood. The kanava piece is 18 inches long, with notches cut 5 inches from each end, curving gently inward. Into these notches are tied three cords. Two additional loops are also made — a hand loop and a foot loop. The device is used for climbing coconut palms.

Handicrafts

Handicrafts are another way of earning money that should be considered part of the wealth of the island. Most of the handicrafts now made for sale were very useful items in everyday life in the past, or are miniature copies of them. Today, handicrafts can be sent overseas or sold locally, especially on Funafuti.

Many hand-crafted items are made and used on Nanumea. Those made by women include: decorated fine mats (epa), sitting mats (papa), brown coconut-leaf dancing skirts (titi fakamanumanu), brightly colored pandanus dancing skirts (titi galegale), finely woven purses (ato), fans (ili), brooms (tui), pandanus strips dyed many colors (galegale lanu valevale), and hats (pūlou). Men also make: model traditional canoes (vaka foliki), wooden bowls with pounders (kumete mo tuki), coconut shell bowls (fāoga), rolled coconut cord (kolokolo), braided coconut cord (kafa), walking sticks (ketuketu), and decorated wooden combs (kau seluselu).